

STAT 312 HW Assignment & Quiz policies

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HW Assignment Policies

Below are very detailed notes on policies and grading for your HW assignments. The goal is to provide detailed instructions and transparency, so that we can avoid confusion and so that every student is operating from the same set of assumptions.

Pro tips

The following will help HW go more smoothly *and* deepen your understanding of the material.

- **Review**
Before sitting down to start HW, review the related course material. Go through the practice problems.
- **Start early**
Start HW early so that you have time to ask questions and absorb the material.
- **AVOID the use of AI for HW Assignments & Quizzes**
If you rely on AI, you will learn very little and will be unprepared for other interactions with the material (eg: in-class discussions, exams, etc). Remember that learning comes from you doing the puzzling, not from you producing a correct answer. Put another way, HW exercises are a bit like lifting weights: it's easy to make a machine do it; it is *you* doing it that matters. If you had a machine lift weights for you, would you expect to build muscle?
- **Be kind to yourself**
You won't know the answer immediately! You'll need to work it out through careful steps.
- **Work together**
Though your HW must be in your own words, you're encouraged to work with classmates on HW, but **ONLY** through the STAT 312 Discussion forum on Canvas.
- **Ask questions**
Swing by office hours. Do not rely on receiving responses outside of weekdays between 8am & 4pm.

Homework and Collaboration

You are highly encouraged to discuss homework questions and course concepts through the **STAT 312 Discussion forum on Canvas** (no other platform is allowed). The purpose of these discussions is to help you understand the material, not to obtain or provide complete solutions. Your submitted work must be your own. All explanations, calculations, reasoning, and written responses should reflect your own understanding.

You **must not**:

- Copy homework answers from another student or allow another student to copy your answers.
- Share complete solutions to homework problems with other students.
- Discuss or exchange homework solutions through unauthorized online forums, group chats, websites, or other platforms outside the approved **STAT 312 Discussion forum on Canvas**.
- Obtain or use homework, exam questions, solutions, solution sets, answer keys, or other restricted materials from **past sections or previous semesters of STAT 312 (or AI)**.
- Use online solution manuals, answer-sharing websites, or other resources that provide solutions to assigned problems.

These resources may make it easier to complete an assignment, but they undermine the purpose of the assignment, which is to develop your own statistical reasoning and problem-solving skills.

STAT 312 Discussion Forum

Use the Canvas **STAT 312 Discussion forum** as your first stop if you get stuck with any of the HW problems:

- Goal: work together as a class so everyone can earn the HW assignments points while learning deeply.
- Ask first: Post questions about HW in the forum. Include the problem number, a brief summary of your approach, and where you're stuck. For coding, share the entire code chunk for the related problem.
- Help each other: If you know (or suspect) the answer, reply! Explaining your reasoning helps everyone learn.
- Share alternatives: Multiple correct methods are welcome - post yours with explanation.
- Be professional: Be respectful, cite any resources you used, and write solutions in your own words.

Timing & flexibility policies

- HW are due by 11:59pm on the corresponding due date. This is to accommodate various work and extracurricular schedules, not to encourage you to stay up late!
- Extension opportunities
Each student can have a 3-day extension on up to 3 HWs. The 3-day extension *includes weekends*. Thus a HW originally due on a Tuesday could be handed in on Friday with an extension. A HW originally due on a Thursday could be handed in on Sunday with an extension. **This policy is in place to provide some flexibility while ensuring that you stay on track to succeed in this course, that you maintain accountability for your own learning, and provide the preceptors & instructor the ability to provide you with timely feedback.**

Extension directions & policies:

- Extensions should be submitted to the relevant HW link on Canvas (the same place you'd hand in a HW if you weren't using an extension). This link will close exactly 3 days after the original deadline, and work submitted after that point will not be accepted.
 - Extensions will be tracked in the Extensions assignment on Canvas. You are expected to be aware of this information (e.g. do not expect me to email you when you are out of extensions).
 - If you use an extension, you should expect a delay in your feedback.
 - **There's no need to request an extension or to tell me you're using an extension. So long as you haven't used up 3 extensions, you can simply take one!**
- Extenuating circumstances
In general, HWs that exceed the extension opportunities will not be graded or accepted for credit. However, there might be additional flexibility in *rare extenuating circumstances*. **Additional flexibility needs to be discussed with me in advance, not assumed.**

Homework Submission Guidelines

- Submit all homework assignments through **Canvas**:
 - Go to **Assignments**
 - Open **HW Assignment**
 - Click the corresponding homework, for example **HW 1**
- If you prefer to work with **pen and pencil**:
 - Download the homework assignment from the [Course Website](#)
 - Print the assignment
 - Complete your work by hand
 - Scan your completed work as a PDF
 - Upload the PDF to Canvas

- If you prefer to use a **writing device** or type your solutions, you may complete the homework electronically and submit the final work directly as a **PDF**.
- You may also need to submit a .R file if the HW involves programming task
- Your work must be **clear, organized, and legible**. Follow these presentation guidelines:
 - Clearly **circle or otherwise mark your final answer** so it can be easily located on the page.
 - Show all necessary work for **nontrivial calculations**. Answers without sufficient supporting work may lose points.
 - Keep your work in the same order as the assigned problems whenever possible.
- Name your submitted PDF using the following format:
firstname_lastname_HW#.pdf
 Example: **john_smith_HW1.pdf**

Quiz Policies

Timing & flexibility policies

Quizzes are available on Canvas and Each quiz assesses your general understanding of the topics covered during the corresponding unit. Quizzes are generally due **three days after the corresponding unit is completed in class, at 11:59 pm Eastern Time**.

You are strongly encouraged to review the lecture notes, class resources, and complete the corresponding Practice Problems before beginning a quiz.

Quiz format, attempts, deadlines

Once you begin a quiz, you must complete it **in one sitting**. The timer will continue running after you start the quiz, so do not begin until you are ready to complete it. Make sure you are in an appropriate location and have appropriate uninterrupted time before starting.

You will have **only one attempt** for each quiz. Before starting, make sure that you:

- understand the material covered in the corresponding unit;
- have reviewed the lecture notes and class resources; and
- have completed the corresponding Practice Problems.

In general, quizzes that are not completed by the deadline cannot be reopened or accepted for credit. Flexibility may be considered in rare extenuating circumstances, particularly when appropriate

notification or documentation is provided through the **Dean's Office**. Such flexibility should not be assumed and should be communicated as early as possible.

Correct answers of quizzes will become available on Canvas on **12:01 am** following the regular deadline.

Testing accommodations

The posted quiz time has already been set to include **2× testing time**. Therefore, if you have an approved testing-time accommodation covered by this additional time, you may use the **entire posted quiz time**.

If you have an approved **limited-distraction testing accommodation**, you may choose an appropriate quiet or limited-distraction location in which to complete the quiz.

Academic integrity

Quizzes must be completed entirely on your own.

You must not:

- communicate with another person about quiz questions while completing the quiz;
- give another student help;
- receive help from another person; or
- use AI tools to obtain assistance with quiz questions.

Communicating with others, giving or receiving help, or using AI during a quiz is considered **cheating**. A violation will result in a **score of zero on the quiz** and will be reported as a case of academic misconduct in accordance with university policy.

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI)

The use of AI tools is **NOT ALLOWED** in this course for HW assignments & quizzes. Limited use may be appropriate for purposes such as getting unstuck with **R-related issues** when R is being used. However, you cannot use AI tools to generate answers or solutions to homework problems or quizzes, *unless* I explicitly state otherwise for a particular assignment.

You are responsible for understanding and being able to explain every step, calculation, argument, interpretation, and conclusion contained in the work you submit. **If unauthorized past resources or AI**

use is suspected, you may be asked to explain or defend your solution and demonstrate your understanding of the submitted work. If you are unable to demonstrate sufficient understanding, the work may receive a score of zero, subject to applicable university academic integrity procedures.

Academic integrity policies

In general, all work that you submit must represent **your own understanding and effort**. You must not present another person's work, solutions obtained from unauthorized resources, or AI-generated work as your own.

Examples of academic integrity violations include, but are not limited to:

- Using HW assignment/Quiz/Exam/graded materials from any past offering of STAT 312, whether at CWRU or elsewhere, unless those materials have been explicitly provided or authorized for use in this course.
- Providing course materials, assignments, quizzes, exams, or other restricted materials to future STAT 312 students.
- Gaining unauthorized access to, using, sharing, or distributing solution sets.
- Submitting another person's work as your own.
- Submitting AI-generated work as your own or using AI in HW/Quizzes where it is not permitted.
- Submitting work that you cannot independently explain or defend.

You should be able to **explain and defend all work that you submit**. Violations of these policies will result in a **score of 0 on the work** and will be reported through the appropriate university academic integrity process.

You must meet the college's expectations around [academic integrity](#) & other [academic policies](#).